Independent Competitive & UX Research Survey for Riverline: Poker Study Products & Interactive Learning Benchmarks

Executive Overview

The commercial poker study ecosystem in 2026 is polarized between **high-cost cloud solver ecosystems** built for high-volume online grinders and **fragmented mobile drill apps** that reduce complex multi-street range interactions into binary quizzes [Judgement]. Across forums such as TwoPlusTwo and r/poker, players consistently voice frustration over four structural problems:

1. **Predatory subscription tiering ("rentalism")**: Market leaders lock essential game formats, bet sizings, and nodelocking behind $39–279/month recurring paywalls (GTO Gecko Simple GTO Alternatives, r/poker Pricing Thread).
2. **False precision and opaque provenance**: Solver trainers routinely grade human decisions to hundredths of a big blind against fragile heads-up equilibrium assumptions, or—in the case of legacy neural networks like PokerSnowie—present uncheckable black-box approximations as authoritative advice (PokerSnowie Review 2026) [Judgement].
3. **The "what" without the "why"**: Most trainers expose a 13×13 frequency matrix or flag a move as an EV loss without explaining the underlying structural drivers (range advantage, nut distribution, blockers, or opponent policy assumptions) (Best GTO Apps 2026, r/poker DTO Thread).
4. **Systematic neglect of home-game and live players**: Almost every commercial product assumes 6-max or 8-max online tables, standard 2x–2.5x preflop opens, heads-up postflop pots, percentage-capped casino rake, and equilibrium opponents—rendering them unable to model limp-family pots, 7x live isolation raises, 4-way flops, custom home-game or ClubGG-style accounting, or the concrete personalities sitting at a weekly kitchen-table game (TwoPlusTwo Live Cash Thread) [Judgement].

By contrasting twelve poker study product families with two mass-market interactive learning leaders—Chess.com Game Review & Lessons and Brilliant.org—this report extracts actionable product, pedagogical, and interface lessons tailored to Riverline's core architecture: an **honest, free, local-first personal poker strategy and study workstation** [Judgement].

1. Master Comparison Matrix: Poker Study Products & Non-Poker UX Benchmarks

Product / Category	Core Features	What Users Love	What Users Complain About (Reviews / Forums)	Pricing Model (2026)	Phone vs. Desktop	Uncertainty & Accuracy Presentation	Home-Game & Live Player Handling	Design Quality [Judgement]
GTO Wizard (Nodelocking Help, Best GTO Apps 2026)	Massive presolved library, custom cloud AI solving (including 3-way & preflop), nodelocking, EV-loss trainer, aggregate reports, hand history analyzer (Nodelocking Blog, r/poker Pricing Thread)	Unmatched library depth, fast cloud AI solver, ability to nodelock opponent leaks, polished web UI, free preflop viewer & educational blog (r/poker Live Thread, r/poker Pricing Thread)	Aggressive multi-tier pricing ("rentalism"), feature walls per format, cognitive overload on complex matrices, unrealistic heads-up LAG assumptions for live games (TwoPlus Two Live Cash Thread, r/poker Pricing Thread)	Free limited tier (preflop + 1 postflop spot/day); paid tiers from 39–49/mo (Starter) to $99/mo (Premium), 129–199/mo (Elite), and $279/mo (Ultra) (Best GTO Apps 2026, Simple GTO Alternatives)	Responsive web app across desktop and mobile browsers; dense data views strongly favor desktop monitors (TwoPlus Two Live Cash Thread, Simple GTO Alternatives)	Exact combo frequencies (0–100%), EV in bb, EV loss per action, and % GTOW score; presents solver equilibrium as exact truth without surfacing tree/abstraction sensitivity to novices (Best GTO Apps 2026) [Judgement]	Has straddle/live-rake trees and nodelocking (in higher tiers), but cannot naturally model multi-limp live pots or persistent home-game player profiles (TwoPlus Two Live Cash Thread)	**High (9/10)**: Industry-standard dark analytical UI, fast matrix rendering, though increasingly cluttered by upsell gates and micro-controls [Judgement]
GTOBase (Simple Poker) (App Store, Best GTO Apps 2026)	Presolved library (>1M solved flops across Spin & Go, HU, MTT, 6-max cash),	Raw speed of strategy viewer, strong Spin & Go and HU hyper coverage, generous free	Steep subscription cost (100–150/mo), mobile app abandoned since July 2023 (v2.09),	Free subset (e.g., HU 100bb); paid plans 75–150/mo ($400/3 mos, $1,200/yr) per library	Desktop web app is primary; iOS app has not been updated since July 2023 and lacks parity with	Displays exact solver frequencies, EV, and equity graphs from Simple Postflop engine;	Zero live or home-game adaptation; engineered strictly for online Spin & Go, HU,	**Medium (6.5/10)**: Fast and functional matrix viewer on web, but neglected mobile shell and brittle

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	strategy viewer, aggregated runout reports, GTO trainer, HH analyzer (App Store)	HU/Spin libraries (App Store, Simple GTO Alternatives)	login/lockout bugs after payment, bizarre unintuitive solves (e.g., UTG calling 3-bets OOP with 33) (App Store, Simple GTO Alternatives)	(Simple GTO Alternatives)	web; no Google Play app (Simple GTO Alternatives)	zero explanation of why strange solver lines occur (App Store) [Judgement]	and standard online MTT/6-max trees (Simple GTO Alternatives)	account UX (App Store) [Judgement]
DTO Poker Trainer (Cash & MTT) (Best GTO Apps 2026, r/poker DTO Thread)	Mobile-first spot drilling for MTT and Cash, instant action grading, virtual ELO/rating progression (Best GTO Apps 2026)	Fast, low-friction mobile drilling loop; affordable $9.99/mo entry point; good positional discipline reminders for intermediate players (Best GTO Apps 2026, r/poker DTO	Free/low tiers hide EV-loss math and grade mixed spots as binary right/wrong (teaching 100% pure play instead of mixing); zero conceptual explanation of *why* a move is bad; split into	Freemium; paid tiers from $9.99/mo (capped at ~31 spots, limited evaluation) up to 29.99–99.99/mo (~87 spots, full EV details) (Best GTO Apps 2026)	Mobile-first (iOS & Android native apps) with companion web access (Best GTO Apps 2026)	Grades actions as Best/Good/Inaccuracy/Blunder; lower tiers mask mixed frequencies by rewarding only the modal (highest-frequency) action (r/poker DTO Thread, Best GTO Apps 2026)	None; uses rigid presolved online MTT and 6-max cash trees with no live sizing, multiway, or home-game support (Best GTO Apps 2026)	**Medium-High (7.5/10)**: Slick one-handed mobile card UI, but shallow analytical inspection and aggressive paywalling of EV context [Judgement]

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		Thread)	separate MTT and Cash apps (r/poker DTO Thread, r/poker DTO Flop Thread)					
Postflop+ & Preflop+ (Crafty Wheel / ThinkGTO) (Postflop+ Official, Preflop+ Official)	Postflop+: presolved postflop drills, real-time range narrowing, ELO & leaderboards, offline pack downloads (Postflop+ Official). Preflop+: Nash push/fold charts, custom ranges, pot odds & combinatorics trainers, bankroll tracker (Preflop+ Official)	True offline play after downloading spot packs; one-time lifetime purchase option ($199.99); Preflop+ math/pot-odds & combinatorics trainers praised for live table prep (Postflop+ Official, Preflop+ Official, Simple GTO Alternatives)	Severe app fragmentation—preflop, postflop, solver, and ranges are split into 5 separate apps with separate subscriptions; no range browser when a drill confuses you; lower Android ratings (3.7★ vs 4.7★ iOS) (Best GTO Apps 2026, Simple	Free daily sample; $14.99/mo, $99.99/yr, or $199.99 lifetime per app (in-app purchases $4.99–199.99) (Best GTO Apps 2026, Simple GTO Alternatives)	Strictly mobile-only (iOS & Android); no desktop or web study environment (Best GTO Apps 2026)	Shows solver action frequencies, EV in bb, and street-by-street range narrowing matrices, but lacks deep conceptual text explanations (Postflop+ Official, Simple GTO Alternatives)	Preflop+ includes a live bankroll tracker and pot-odds drills useful for live players (Preflop+ Official), but postflop sims remain standard online HU trees (Best GTO Apps 2026)	**Medium-High (7.5/10)**: Clean, thumb-friendly mobile UI and offline architecture, undermined by 5-app ecosystem fragmentation [Judgement]

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			GTO Alternatives)					
Simple GTO Trainer (Simple Poker) (Official Page, Simple GTO Alternatives)	Desktop drill engine for custom Simple Postflop and PioSolver solutions, custom regular/exploit drills, real-time turn/river solving via local engine, session EV/range analytics (Official Page)	Only major trainer that lets power users import and drill their own custom/nodelocked PioSolver or Simple Postflop trees locally (Simple GTO Alternatives)	Windows-only (requires Parallels/Boot Camp on Mac); "bring your own solutions" model means buying a $299–€800 solver or 49–349.99 cloud packs on top of the trainer license; archaic 1-PC license deactivation via Skype (Simple Postflop Official, Simple GTO Alternatives)	Free version (custom drills only, excludes Core GTO Pack); Pro is $99/3 mos, $149/6 mos, or $199/yr + 59–349.99 per training pack (Official Page, Simple GTO Alternatives)	Windows desktop only; zero mobile or web support (Simple GTO Alternatives)	Reports exact EV loss, frequency distribution, and player's realized action frequencies vs. imported solver file (Official Page)	Power users can drill custom nodelocked live trees if they own a desktop solver, but out-of-the-box packs are 100% online cash/MTT/Spins (Official Page, Simple GTO Alternatives)	**Low-Medium (5.5/10)**: Functional 2018-era Windows utility; utilitarian tables and graphs with high setup friction (Simple GTO Alternatives) [Judgement]
Range Trainer Pro	Web-based preflop range	Active-recall drilling of preflop	Expensive recurring cost (30–	Limited free features;	Responsive web app	Pure chart-matching	Supports custom live	**Medium (6.5/10)**: Clean

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(LearnPro Poker / CLP) (YouTube Review, r/poker Preflop Thread)	viewer, custom range storage/editor, active-recall flashcard/table drill mode, heat maps (YouTube Review, r/poker Range Charts Thread)	ranges across stack depths; ability to enter and drill custom ranges like flashcards; favored by live MTT pros for pre-session warmups (r/poker Range Charts Thread, Poker.org Jim Reid Interview)	37/mo) just for preflop chart memorization; heavily tournament-oriented; rote memorization of 50+ charts without teaching underlying range construction principles (r/poker Preflop Thread, r/poker Preflop NLH Thread)	~30–37/mo subscription or bundled with preflop bootcamps/LearnPro Poker (r/poker Preflop Thread)	usable on desktop and mobile browsers (YouTube Review)	accuracy (correct/incorrect vs stored chart frequencies); no solver EV or uncertainty modeling (r/poker Range Charts Thread)	cash/MTT preflop charts (e.g., multiway flatting and live sizing charts from bootcamps), though limited to preflop (Chasing Poker Greatness Bootcamp)	matrix and flashcard drill layout, but narrow functional scope relative to subscription price [Judgement]
Flopzilla / Flopzilla Pro (Download & Changelog, Purchase Page)	Ultra-fast range-vs-board hit/texture calculator, multiway range-vs-range equity (up to 3 players in Pro), combo/sui	Legendary $25 lifetime price (includes v1 + Pro + lifetime updates on 2 PCs); instantaneous visual feedback	Windows-only desktop binary; steep technical UI learning curve with dense small toggles; inconsiste	$25 one-time lifetime license for 2 computers; all upgrades included; zero subscriptions (Purchase	Windows desktop only (requires 1GB RAM, Windows 7+); no mobile or web version (Download &	100% deterministic combinatorial and equity math: exact combo counts, percentages, and card-remo	Excellent for modeling loose/passive live or home-game opponent ranges, 3-way equities, and	**High Utility / Dated Aesthetic (7.5/10)**: Masterclass in high-density reactive analytical controls and local-first

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	t filtering, preflop bunching effect, pie-chart range composition, GTO+ direct export (Download & Changelog)	on how a range hits a flop/turn/river; completely local/offline file storage (Purchase Page, Download & Changelog)	ncies in top-% hand ordering vs tools like Equilab; blocks execution if PokerStars client is open (Download & Changelog, TwoPlusTwo Range Thread, TwoPlusTwo Bug Thread)	Page)	Changelog)	val/bunching adjustments—never invents fake strategy verdicts (Download & Changelog) [Judgement]	preflop fold bunching, though users must build ranges manually (Download & Changelog) [Judgement]	speed, wrapped in a classic Windows desktop skin (Download & Changelog) [Judgement]
PokerSnowie (Pricing Page, AI Weaknesses)	Self-play neural network coach; practice play vs AI, Scenario Evaluation, hand import & grading, "Error Rate" & Game Balance stats (Pricing Page,	Gentle, motivating play-and-grade loop for beginners; fixes major loose-passive leaks; honest "AI Weaknesses" documentation page (AI Weaknes	Not a true solver—2013 neural net uses only 4 bet sizes (0.25x, 0.5x, 1x, 2x pot), forces 1 bet size for the whole range, folds solver-standard EP	$29.90/mo billed monthly or $199.90/yr 16.66/mo first year, +VAT in EU); single unified tier (Pricing Page, PokerSnowie Review 2026)	Windows & Mac desktop apps; iOS and Android apps are effectively abandonware (last updated 2018/2019) (PokerSnowie Review 2026)	Outputs an "Error Rate" (EV cost of errors) from neural-net interpolation without auditable equilibrium math; admits on its website that it makes pot-odds	Explicitly documented failure mode: because Snowie never open-limped during self-play, its advice against live/home-game limpers and large overbets is	**Low-Medium (5/10)**: Clean table play loop on desktop, but stagnant 2016 engine and broken mobile apps (PokerSnowie Review

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	PokerSnowie Review 2026)	ses, PokerSnowie Review 2026)	hands, fails vs limpers/3x+ overbets, and mobile apps haven't updated since 2018–2019 (2.4★ iOS) (AI Weaknesses, PokerSnowie Review 2026)			mistakes in all-ins and non-GTO lines (AI Weaknesses, PokerSnowie Review 2026)	inaccurate (AI Weaknesses, PokerSnowie Review 2026)	2026) [Judgement]
Upswing Poker Lab (Lab 2.0) & Lucid GTO (Upswing Lab Tracks, r/Poker_Theory Review)	Structured video/text curriculum (100+ modules, 600+ videos organized into 6 Learning Tracks), preflop charts, Discord group; sister app Lucid GTO offers browser/ mobile	Clear beginner onboarding ("Four-Category System"), dedicated 28-hour "Live Cash Game Bankroll Booster" track, active Discord, and Lucid's flat pricing +	Passive video consumption with near-zero interactive exercises/ homework inside the Lab; inconsistencies between older videos and text; information overload in Lab 2.0 videos;	Upswing Lab: ~$99/mo (plus standalone courses at $999); Lucid GTO: Free Basic tier (unlimited preflop + 5 postflop/day), Pro $49/mo or $490/yr (r/poker Modules Thread,	Web video portal + Preflop Prodigy / Lucid cross-platform apps (Web, iOS, Android, Windows, Mac, Linux) (Upswing Lab Tracks, Best GTO Apps 2026)	Lab teaches qualitative hand-category heuristics first ("Four Categories") before solver frequencies; Lucid uses presolved cash sims (Upswing Lab Tracks, Best GTO Apps 2026)	Dedicated 9-module "Live Cash Game Bankroll Booster" track (Gary Blackwood, Mike Finstein) and Garrett Adelstein live cash course (Upswing Lab Tracks)	**Medium-High (7/10)**: Well-organized curriculum tracks, though users complain on Reddit that the video LMS platform feels clunky and passive (r/Poker_ Theory

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	cash drills + daily Cardle quiz (Upswing Lab Tracks, Best GTO Apps 2026)	generous free Basic tier (Upswing Lab Tracks, Best GTO Apps 2026)	"$999 signature courses" upsell fatigue (r/Poker_Theory Review, r/poker Modules Thread)	Best GTO Apps 2026)				Review) [Judgement]
Run It Once (RIO Courses & Vision GTO Trainer) (RIO Learning Paths, Vision FAQ)	7,300+ pro training videos, curated Learning Paths (Foundations, US Poker Sites, WSOP Prep, Mental Game), *From The Ground Up* courses, and Vision GTO Trainer (MonkerSolver-backed web/mobile trainer) (RIO Learning	World-class elite instructors (Phil Galfond, Sauce123, Peter Clarke), transparent solver parameter documentation in Vision FAQ (exact rake, buckets, iterations/node), and recent Vision exploit drills (RIO Learning Paths, Vision FAQ, RIO Hunter	Unstructured library can feel like "random content by random people" outside courses; passive picture-in-picture chart lectures; $49 FTGU course lacks built-in interactive exercises (r/poker Upswing Review, r/Poker_Theory Review)	Essential & Elite video memberships (~$100/mo Elite); standalone courses from $49 (*From The Ground Up*); separate Vision subscription (r/poker Modules Thread, r/Poker_Theory Review)	Responsive web platform and mobile video app; Vision GTO Trainer is browser-based and mobile-optimized (RIO Learning Paths, Vision FAQ)	Gold-standard transparency in Vision FAQ: explicitly discloses MonkerSolver bucket abstractions (30,30,30), I/N volatility, PokerStars 500 Zoom rake assumptions, and human pro sizing simplifications where EV loss was negligible (Vision	Includes "US Poker Sites" and "WSOP Prep" video learning paths (RIO Learning Paths), plus limp-raise-call and 3-way pots in Vision (Vision FAQ), but remains primarily online-pro focused	**High (8/10)**: Editorial, serious, adult tone; respects player intelligence and documents model assumptions honestly (Vision FAQ) [Judgement]

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	Paths, Vision FAQ)	Cichy)				FAQ)		
Hold'em Manager 3 (HM3) & Hand2Note (H2N) (HM3 Review, H2N vs HM3)	Local hand-history database, real-time table HUD, Hand Replayer, Situational Views (HM3), Smart Reports, Range Research (MDA), Decision Analysis (action profit), and hand-linked stat notes (H2N) (HM3 Review, H2N Review)	Empirical ground-truth tracking of actual played hands; H2N's blazing speed (10,000 hands/sec import), compact DB, "Reg-vs-Fish exclusion" filter, and embedding graphical hands directly inside player/stat notes (H2N vs HM3, H2N Review)	Windows-only (HM3 & H2N 3 lack Mac support; H2N 4 added Mac); steep configuration complexity; HM3 Trustpilot sits at 2.2/5 with legacy upgrade obsolescence complaints; HUDs banned on GGPoker/Partypoker and restricted on PokerStars (HM3 Review, HM3 Trustpilot, H2N Review)	HM3: $60 (Small Stakes) to 100–160 one-time license (includes 1 yr updates) (HM3 Review). H2N: Free BASE tier across all stakes; paid subscriptions $19.90/mo (EDGE), $29.99/mo (ASIA), $49/mo (PRO) (H2N Review)	Desktop-only (Windows for HM3; Windows & macOS in H2N 4); zero phone/tablet interface (HM3 Review, H2N vs HM3)	Reports empirical sample frequencies, All-in Adjusted EV, and Action Profit; however, does not warn users when small-sample postflop stats are statistically meaningless noise (r/poker Live Thread, H2N Review) [Judgement]	Useless for physical live or home games because they require automated online hand-history text files (though H2N supports ClubGG/PPPoker via converters/Asia tier) (H2N vs HM3, H2N Review)	**HM3: 6/10; H2N: 8/10**: H2N's popup range matrices, Compact Hand View, and stat-linked notes are best-in-class for dense desktop review, whereas HM3 feels bloated (H2N vs HM3) [Judgement]
Coaching & Phone	PokerCoaching:	Plain-English "why"	PokerCoaching is	PokerCoaching:	True cross-platf	PokerCoaching	Best live focus in	**High (8/10)**:

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Trainer Apps (PokerCoaching / PeakGTO, GTO Gecko, Live Poker Trainer, Octopi) (PokerCoaching Pricing, Live Poker Trainer, Best GTO Apps 2026)	interactive multi-street coach quizzes + "Clear the Charts" + PeakGTO drill bundle (PokerCoaching Pricing, r/poker Preflop Thread). GTO Gecko: 3-way postflop sims + SHAP plain-English explanations (Best GTO Apps 2026). Live Poker Trainer: drills vs 4 archetypes (Fish, Nit, Maniac, GTO) with Easy/Med/Hard sizing buckets	explanations (GTO Gecko SHAP); training against realistic non-GTO archetypes with simplified sizing buckets (Live Poker Trainer); full-hand pro commentary quizzes (PokerCoaching) (Best GTO Apps 2026, Live Poker Trainer, r/Poker_Theory Review)	criticized as "wildly expensive" ($147/mo or 999–1,299/yr) with buggy web chart maintenance (PokerCoaching Pricing, r/Poker_Theory Review, r/poker Preflop Thread); mobile apps collect tracking/device identifiers (Live Poker Trainer)	$999/yr$ (1,299/yr w/ PeakGTO; $599/yr PeakGTO solo) (PokerCoaching Pricing). GTO Gecko: Free daily tier; $24.99–39.99/mo ($149.99–239.99/yr) (Best GTO Apps 2026). Live Poker Trainer: $19.99/mo or $119.99/yr (Live Poker Trainer). Octopi: Free tier; $200–600/yr (Best GTO Apps 2026)	orm native mobile (iOS/Android) + web synchronization (Best GTO Apps 2026, Live Poker Trainer)	quizzes score choices 0–10 by coach consensus; GTO Gecko pairs EV loss with ML factor weights and documents solution verification publicly; Live Poker Trainer tracks ELO per archetype (Best GTO Apps 2026, Live Poker Trainer)	the market: GTO Gecko includes 3-way postflop & straddle/ante cash (Best GTO Apps 2026); Live Poker Trainer explicitly targets $1/2$ and $2/5$ live exploits vs Fish/Nit/Maniac (Live Poker Trainer)	Modern mobile-native UX (especially GTO Gecko and Live Poker Trainer's difficulty buckets), though subscription walls remain heavy [Judgement]

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	(Live Poker Trainer). Octopi: pro TV hand Vault + community (Best GTO Apps 2026)							
CONTRAST 1: Chess.com (Lessons & Game Review) (Membership, How Game Review Works)	Post-game interactive Game Review (Advantage Graph, CAPS2 0–100 Accuracy, Move Classifications, Key Moves + one-click "Retry"), 500k+ puzzles, step-by-step Master lessons, Play Coach (Membership, How Game Review Works)	Seamless transition from playing a game to reviewing key mistakes; "Retry" button lets you replay a critical mistake immediately; plain-English visual arrows ("Show Fork") make engine analysis approachable for beginners (How Game Review	Paywalling open-source Stockfish behind $10–17$/mo when Lichess is 100% free; shallow/wrong AI Coach text explanations for stronger players; move classifications change between fast post-game screen and deep review;	Free (1 Game Review/day, limited puzzles/lessons); Gold $4.17/mo, Platinum $6.67/mo, Diamond $10/mobill$ 16.99/mo monthly) (Membership, r/chess Pricing Thread)	Best-in-class parity across web, iOS, and Android; settings sync, though engine depth can differ between mobile and cloud web analysis (How Game Review Works, r/chess Pricing Thread)	Uses **Expected Points Model** (0.00–1.00 win probability adjusted for player rating) for move labels (Move Classifications) and **CAPS2** to curve-fit Accuracy into a "school test" 50–95 range so low-rated players don't feel bad (CAPS2 Accuracy)	Supports over-the-board (OTB) PGN import, play-a-friend in person on the app, and opening linkages from reviewed games straight to study lessons (How Game Review Works, CAPS2 Accuracy)	**Very High (9/10)**: Benchmark consumer UX for turning intimidating engine trees into a guided "Key Moments → Retry → Lesson" loop, marred only by paywall and vanity-score dark patterns [Judgement]

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		Works, r/chess Pricing Thread)	manipulative "Brilliant!!" dopamine inflation (How Game Review Works, r/chess Pricing Thread)					
CONTRAST 2: Brilliant.org (Free vs Premium Help, Headway Review)	Interactive visual STEM lessons (40+ topics across math, CS, data, science), on-screen manipulatives, Koji adaptive one-on-one AI tutor, daily streaks, XP & leagues (Headway Review, Free vs Premium Help)	"Learn by doing" interactive diagrams and draggable visual manipulatives (Concrete → Pictorial → Abstract progression); concise bite-sized concepts instead of long passive videos; accessible public math wiki (Headway Review, r/math	"Edutainment" trap: gives the illusion of mastery without sufficient drill volume; abrupt difficulty cliffs ("Monty Python bridge" leaps from trivial to complex); restrictive 2-keys/day free limit with forced sequential lock; surprise $240 annual	Free tier limited to 2 keys/day (no skipping ahead, includes ads); Premium ~$30/mo monthly or ~~$20/mo billed annually~~ ($240/yr) 40/mo (Free vs Premium Help, Headway Review)	Seamless parity across web, iOS, and Android with touch-first interactive SVG/canvas widgets (Free vs Premium Help)	No probabilistic uncertainty display; uses step-by-step interactive scaffolding and Koji Socratic hints to diagnose where a learner's mental model broke down (Free vs Premium Help, Headway Review)	N/A (STEM platform), though its "15-minute daily habit" framing targets casual adult learners outside formal classrooms (Headway Review, r/math Brilliant Thread)	**Very High Visual Craft / Mixed Pedagogy (8.5/10)**: World-class interactive manipulatives and clean typography, weakened by Duolingo-style streak/keygating and insufficient practice depth (r/math Brilliant Thread) [Judgement]

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		Brilliant Thread)	auto-renewal complaints (Headway Review, Free vs Premium Help, r/math Brilliant Thread)					

2. Deep-Dive Analysis Across the Twelve Poker & Two Contrast Products

2.1 Cloud Solver Ecosystems: GTO Wizard & GTOBase

GTO Wizard and GTOBase represent the dominant cloud-library paradigm in modern poker study. Both pre-compute millions of game-tree nodes and serve them through browser-based 13×13 range matrices coupled with an EV-loss trainer (Best GTO Apps 2026). What users genuinely love about GTO Wizard is the zero-latency transition between playing a hand in the Trainer and inspecting the full range matrix in Study Mode ("Study mode shortcut in the Trainer"), alongside custom cloud AI solving and nodelocking (Nodelocking Blog). However, user sentiment on TwoPlusTwo and r/poker exposes two severe vulnerabilities that directly inform Riverline's strategy [Judgement]:

1. **Subscription Exhaustion and Artificial Feature Slicing**: After GTO Wizard's March 2026 price hikes, plans span from $39–49/month (Starter, restricted to single-bet-size solutions) to $99/month (Premium) and $129–279/month (Elite/Ultra) (Simple GTO Alternatives). In a widely discussed February 2026 r/poker thread ("GTO Wizard WTF"), users compared the five-by-five tier matrix to leasing a car where "second and third gear unlock on premium, reverse costs extra, and if you want different driver profiles, that's the ultra lease." Similarly, GTOBase charges $100–150/month ($1,200/year) while leaving its iOS app untouched since July 2023 and suffering from account-lockout bugs reported by paying subscribers (GTOBase App Store).
2. **Dangerous Misapplication by Live and Recreational Players**: In the TwoPlusTwo Live No-Limit Cash forum, low-stakes live players describe paying $89 for a month of GTO Wizard only to find that the solver assumes heads-up pots against a hyper-aggressive equilibrium opponent who 5-bets AQo and calls two streets with backdoor draws. Worse, as veteran poster Tomark documented in that thread, piecemeal adoption of solver outputs actively damages live win rates: copying GTO's 33% flop range c-bet in a loose

live game without knowing how to execute polarized turn overbet double-barrels and river bluffs encourages calling stations to see cheap turns accurately instead of punishing their inelasticity with 2/3-pot value bets (TwoPlusTwo Live Cash Thread) [Judgement].

2.2 Mobile-First Drillers: DTO Poker, Postflop+, Preflop+, and GTO Gecko / Live Poker Trainer

Mobile trainers emerged to solve the friction of sitting at a desktop tower. DTO Poker popularized swipe-speed spot drilling on smartphones, while Crafty Wheel Studios built Postflop+ and Preflop+ with offline spot pack downloads and a one-time $199.99 lifetime purchase option (Best GTO Apps 2026). More recently, GTO Gecko and its sister app Live Poker Trainer introduced machine-learning SHAP explanations and opponent-archetype drilling. Yet user reviews highlight critical pedagogical flaws across mobile drillers:

- **Modal-Action Grading Teaches False Purity**: On r/poker, users note that DTO Poker's biggest drawback is that "DTO always says the best answer is that which you should do most (but not all) of the time," training players into predictable 100% pure lines when the underlying spot is a close mix (Best GTO Apps 2026). This directly validates Riverline's locked principle that **one-click answers represent a dominant/preferred action, never silent 100% purity**, and that close mixes must read as mixed verdicts (e.g., *"3-Bet or Call"*) [Judgement].
- **App Fragmentation vs. Coherent Workstation**: Crafty Wheel Studios splits preflop push/fold (Preflop+), postflop drills (Postflop+), tree lookups (Solver+), and charts (GTO Ranges+) into separate standalone mobile apps with separate subscriptions, and provides no range explorer inside Postflop+ when a drill result confuses the user (Best GTO Apps 2026).
- **SHAP Explanations and Difficulty Buckets as UX Breakthroughs**: Two mobile innovations stand out positively. First, GTO Gecko uses a factor-analysis layer to translate solver actions into plain-English structural drivers (range advantage, blockers, equity distribution, stack depth). Second, Live Poker Trainer lets players drill against four explicit opponent archetypes (*Fish, Nit, Maniac, GTO*) and offers three bet-sizing difficulty tiers (*Easy* simplified sizes, *Medium* small/medium/large buckets, and *Hard* exact solver sizes) (Live Poker Trainer App Store).

2.3 Desktop Calculators, Custom Trainers & Neural Nets: FlopzillaPro, Simple GTO Trainer, Range Trainer Pro, and PokerSnowie

- **Flopzilla / FlopzillaPro**: At $25 for a lifetime two-computer license with all upgrades included (Flopzilla Purchase), FlopzillaPro remains one of the most beloved tools in poker software history [Judgement]. Its secret is **epistemic honesty and instant reactivity**: it never pretends to be an oracle telling you what action to take; instead, it computes exact combinatorial hit distributions, multiway range-vs-range equities, card-removal/bunching effects, and street-by-street filter pass-throughs in milliseconds (Flopzilla Download). Its weaknesses are its Windows-only architecture, dense legacy UI, and minor hand-ordering discrepancies compared to tools like Equilab (TwoPlusTwo Range Thread).
- **Simple GTO Trainer**: Simple GTO Trainer ($199/year Pro plus 59–349.99 packs) is the only desktop tool built specifically to let players import their own local Simple Postflop or PioSolver files and drill them with real-time EV feedback (Simple GTO Alternatives).

However, its Windows-only requirement, expensive add-on packs, and manual Skype license deactivation make it hostile to casual or cross-platform users (Simple GTO Alternatives).

- **Range Trainer Pro (RTP)**: Built within the LearnProPoker / Crush Live Poker orbit (RTP YouTube Review), Range Trainer Pro focuses on storing custom preflop charts and drilling them via active-recall flashcards (r/poker Range Charts Thread). While tournament pros like Jim Reid praise RTP for pre-event stack-depth warmups (Poker.org Interview), forum users criticize paying $30–37/month for brute-force memorization of 50+ static charts without learning *why* ranges expand or contract (r/poker Preflop Thread).
- **PokerSnowie**: PokerSnowie ($29.90/month or $199.90/year) is a cautionary tale in strategy architecture [Judgement]. Because it relies on a 2013-era self-play neural network rather than equilibrium calculation, it restricts play to four bet sizes (25%, 50%, 100%, 200% pot), forces a single bet size across its entire range, folds standard solver EP opens (never opening suited connectors below T9s or pairs below 44 UTG), and breaks down against limpers and large overbets (PokerSnowie Review 2026, PokerSnowie AI Weaknesses). Ironically, the single best thing about PokerSnowie is its public **AI Weaknesses** page—which candidly illustrates a concrete all-in flush+gutshot spot where a human calculates 1.6:1 pot odds vs 2:1 card odds (clear fold), whereas the neural network hallucinates a call because it interpolates patterns rather than computing exact pot economics (PokerSnowie AI Weaknesses).

2.4 Curriculum & Video Platforms: Upswing Lab, Run It Once, and PokerCoaching.com

Curriculum platforms attempt to teach conceptual frameworks rather than raw matrices:

- **Upswing Poker Lab (Lab 2.0)**: Organizes 600+ videos into six structured Learning Tracks, starting with Doug Polk and Ryan Fee's "Four-Category System" (*No Limit Simplified*) and including a dedicated 9-module, 28-hour *Live Cash Game Bankroll Booster* track (Upswing Lab Tracks). Yet on r/Poker_Theory, learners complain that the Lab is overwhelmingly passive video with almost zero interactive exercises, that text summaries sometimes contradict older videos, and that newer Lab 2.0 theory videos suffer from unpaused information overload.
- **Run It Once (RIO) & Vision**: RIO combines elite conceptual instruction (Phil Galfond, Peter Clarke's *From The Ground Up*) with Vision GTO Trainer. Vision's documentation is a benchmark for **provenance transparency**: its FAQ explicitly tells users the exact MonkerSolver abstraction buckets (30,30,30 / Perfect, Large, Large), volatility thresholds (I/N), PokerStars 500 Zoom rake model (5%, 1200msb), and where human pros simplified bet sizes (e.g., replacing a theoretical 1/10-pot monotone bet with 33% pot because the EV loss was negligible) (Vision FAQ).
- **PokerCoaching.com & PeakGTO**: Jonathan Little's platform (PokerCoaching Pricing) stands out for active learning—interactive multi-street video quizzes where a coach grades every possible choice on a 0–10 scale and explains why, paired with homework webinars and the "Clear the Charts" preflop progression game (r/Poker_Theory Review, r/poker Preflop Thread). However, its $147/month (999–$1,299/year) pricing alienates recreational players (PokerCoaching Pricing, r/Poker_Theory Review).

2.5 Database Trackers & Review Suites: Hold'em Manager 3 (HM3) &

Hand2Note (H2N)

While Hold'em Manager 3 and Hand2Note are built around online real-time HUDs (which Riverline explicitly rejects as real-time assistance), their **off-table review and note-taking workflows** contain high-value lessons for Riverline's Saved, Hand Review, and Personal Strategy domains [Judgement]:

- **Hand2Note's Contextual Notes & Compact Hand View**: Unlike legacy trackers where player notes are a flat text scratchpad, Hand2Note lets users **embed played hands graphically inside a note** and **attach notes directly to specific statistical nodes** (e.g., attaching a river overbet read directly to the Bet River stat) (H2N Review).
- **Reg-vs-Fish Exclusion & Pool Research**: Hand2Note recognizes that players do not use one universal strategy against all opponents; its "Reg-vs-Fish situations" filter automatically separates hands played against recreational players from reg-vs-reg samples so baseline frequencies are not polluted (H2N vs HM3, H2N Review). This parallels Riverline's separation of named Profiles and Modes [Judgement].

2.6 Non-Poker UX Contrast 1: Chess.com (Lessons & Game Review)

Chess.com is widely praised by casual and intermediate players on r/chess for making post-game engine analysis effortless compared to raw Stockfish lines on Lichess. Its UX succeeds through a three-step post-game funnel (How Game Review Works):

1. **Macro Story First (Advantage Graph & Key Moments)**: Immediately after a game, an advantage graph shows where the game swung, and the "Next Key Move" button skips trivial book/forced moves to land directly on the 3–5 pivotal decisions of the match (How Game Review Works).
2. **Immediate Active "Retry" Before Passive Reveal**: When the user hits a Mistake or Blunder, Game Review does not just dump the engine's principal variation; it offers a **Retry** button so the player can attempt to find the better move on the board first, accompanied by optional visual hint buttons (*"Show Fork"*, *"Show Lost Piece"*, *"Show Idea"*) (How Game Review Works).
3. **Contextual Curriculum Handoff**: Inside the review of the last book move, Chess.com displays the opening name, how many times the user has played it, their historical win rate, and a direct link to a targeted lesson on that exact opening (How Game Review Works).

However, Chess.com also exhibits **three anti-patterns** that Riverline must avoid [Judgement]:

- **Manipulative Score Curving (CAPS2) & "Brilliant!!" Inflation**: In its official CAPS2 documentation, Chess.com admits it changed its Accuracy math so that scores fall between 50 and 95 ("replicate the feeling of being graded on a test in school") because low raw scores "made some people feel bad." Furthermore, its Move Classification V2 documentation states that it is deliberately "more generous in defining a piece sacrifice [Brilliant move] and Great Move for newer players compared to those who are higher-rated." Experienced players on r/chess mock this as patronizing ego-flattery ("patting me on the head and saying 'you're so good, look at all the exclamation points'").
- **Depth Discrepancy Whiplash**: Because the game-over popup runs a fast shallow pass while full Game Review runs a deeper pass (and mobile vs web can use different engine depths), a move praised as "Brilliant" on the game-over screen can be downgraded moments later inside Game Review (How Game Review Works).

- **Shallow Template Explanations**: While beginners appreciate plain-English bubbles ("This move exposes X"), intermediate players on r/chess complain that the automated Coach frequently misidentifies the strategic point of a position once tactics extend beyond two moves.

2.7 Non-Poker UX Contrast 2: Brilliant.org

Brilliant.org is the gold standard for **interactive visual explanation** in consumer EdTech. Rather than lecturing via 40-minute videos, every concept requires the learner to manipulate a geometric, algebraic, or logical object directly on screen—following the Singapore Math progression of **Concrete → Pictorial → Abstract** (r/math Brilliant Thread, Headway Review). Its newer AI tutor, **Koji**, works inside concepts to ask guiding diagnostic questions when a user is stuck rather than immediately revealing the answer (Free vs Premium Help).
Yet discussions on r/math expose why Brilliant is often criticized as **"edutainment"**:

- **The "Monty Python Bridge" Difficulty Cliff**: Learners report solving two trivial warm-up questions in their head and then abruptly hitting a problem that requires a full page of unguided derivation, because lessons skip intermediate scaffolding (r/math Brilliant Thread).
- **Insufficient Repetition for Mastery**: Brilliant optimizes for novelty—moving the user rapidly from one shiny visual concept to the next—without providing enough deliberate practice problems to cement procedural fluency (r/math Brilliant Thread).
- **Coercive Free-Tier Gating**: Free users are restricted to 2 "keys" per day and are **prohibited from skipping ahead** to topics they actually need, forcing linear progression unless they pay ~$240/year upfront (Free vs Premium Help, Headway Review).

3. Product Strategy Synthesis for Riverline: ADOPT, ADAPT, DIFFERENTIATE, REJECT

Grounded in Riverline's architecture (DecisionContext → StrategyProvider → StrategyResult, Profile · Mode · Spot Context separation, local-first storage, canonical PokerState vs lossy Scenario Mode, and strict claim/provenance truthfulness), below is the categorized action plan [Judgement].

3.1 ADOPT (Fits Riverline's Principles Directly)

1. **Direct Manipulation & Reactive Combinatorial Filtering (from FlopzillaPro & Brilliant.org)**:
    - *Evidence*: Users love FlopzillaPro's instant visual feedback showing how a 13×13 range decomposes into hand categories, draws, and blocker counts across streets, and Brilliant's Concrete → Pictorial → Abstract manipulatives.
    - *Riverline Fit*: Adopt reactive, deterministic structural inspection in Analyze and Equity where hovering or selecting hand classes, board cards, or dead cards immediately updates exact combo counts, card-removal effects, and next-card outcomes without inventing unverified solver EV claims [Judgement].
2. **Explicit Model & Assumption Provenance Disclosure (from Run It Once Vision & PokerSnowie's Weaknesses Page)**:
    - *Evidence*: RIO Vision's FAQ builds immense trust with serious players by

documenting exact rake models, bucket abstractions, and sizing simplifications, while PokerSnowie's AI Weaknesses page earns respect for openly showing where its engine fails (e.g., all-in pot-odds vs neural-net intuition).
    - *Riverline Fit*: Directly reinforces Riverline's inline Provenance & limitations disclosure and StrategyClaimPolicy—every strategy output in Riverline must state whether it comes from the deterministic heuristic baseline, an authorized local reference pack (REFERENCE-PACK-001), or the user's Personal Strategy profile, along with exact coverage boundaries [Judgement].
3. **Post-Hand "Key Decisions" Triage & Immediate Re-Drill Handoff (from Chess.com Game Review)**:
    - *Evidence*: Chess.com Game Review prevents post-game fatigue by highlighting the 3–5 pivotal decisions of a completed game, letting the player click **Retry** on the board before revealing the analysis, and linking directly to a targeted drill/lesson.
    - *Riverline Fit*: Aligns with Riverline's Full Hand Review, Study Inbox, and Same Spot / Similar Spot re-drill routes—surfacing top high-leverage decisions from a completed or imported hand and letting the user jump straight from terminal Review into Analyze, Save as Spot, or targeted Training [Judgement].
4. **Hand-Linked & Context-Linked Annotations (from Hand2Note)**:
    - *Evidence*: Hand2Note outclasses older trackers by allowing players to attach notes directly to a specific situation/stat and embed concrete played hands inside notes (H2N vs HM3).
    - *Riverline Fit*: Adopt structured linking between Saved study objects (Hands and Spots), Personal Strategy approaches, and user notes/tags so that a saved hand or calibration conflict serves as clickable evidence attached to a specific strategic node [Judgement].
5. **Offline-First Persistence & Zero-Latency Local Execution (from FlopzillaPro & Postflop+)**:
    - *Evidence*: Commuters and live players praise Postflop+ and FlopzillaPro for working 100% offline with instant local file saves and backup recovery (newdefs3.txt corruption recovery in FlopzillaPro v2.1.6).
    - *Riverline Fit*: Confirms Riverline's local-first persistence model where every calibration observation, training record, and saved hand is durably stored on-device immediately, with non-destructive local JSON export/import [Judgement].

3.2 ADAPT (Needs Changes to Stay Honest, Free, and Local-First)

1. **Plain-Language "Why" Explanations (Adapt from GTO Gecko SHAP & Chess.com Coach)**:
    - *What they do*: GTO Gecko uses an ML SHAP layer to explain solver actions in English, and Chess.com uses an automated Coach bubble. However, r/chess users complain that black-box AI coach text often hallucinates wrong strategic reasons.
    - *How Riverline must adapt it*: Keep Riverline's Facts | Explain split strictly grounded in canonical, deterministic RangeAnalysisFacts and DecisionContext economics (pot odds, required fold equity, exact blocker counts, position, stack-to-pot geometry, and supplied range composition). Never allow an explanation layer to invent poker math or unverified solver narratives [Judgement].
2. **Opponent Archetypes & Sizing Simplification (Adapt from Live Poker Trainer & Hand2Note)**:

    - *What they do*: Live Poker Trainer lets players drill against four hardcoded opponent types (*Fish, Nit, Maniac, GTO*) with *Easy/Medium/Hard* bet-size buckets, and Hand2Note filters out "Reg-vs-Fish" hands.
    - *How Riverline must adapt it*: Instead of hardcoding four opaque black-box bots, map environments and styles through Riverline's transparent three-layer model: user-named **Profiles** (e.g., *Thursday Home Game*, *ClubGG 10-Max*, *Live 1/3*) + up to three user-named **Approaches/Modes** per profile (e.g., *Normal*, *Cautious*, *Pressure*) + explicit **Opponent Policy** assumptions in Bluff/Exploit Teacher. Also adopt simplified, realistic bet-sizing families rather than forcing 7-size solver menus [Judgement].
3. **Borderline-First & Spaced-Repetition Drilling (Adapt from LivePokerTheory, GTO Gecko & Range Trainer Pro)**:
    - *What they do*: Indie tools like LivePokerTheory and GTO Gecko focus drills on borderline hands and re-serve missed spots via spaced repetition, rather than dealing AA and 72o repeatedly.
    - *How Riverline must adapt it*: Channel adaptive questioning into Riverline's Teach Riverline Next uncertainty queue (RANGE-CAL-002C/D) and Training Memory 24-hour Revisit queue—using transparent, deterministic boundary detection (e.g., testing K9s/K8s/K7s or A8o/A7o around a profile's RFI threshold) while separating *intended calibration evidence* from *observed training actions* [Judgement].
4. **"Bring Your Own Reference" Extensibility (Adapt from Simple GTO Trainer)**:
    - *What they do*: Simple GTO Trainer lets users import external solver files, but requires a Windows PC and paid solver licenses.
    - *How Riverline must adapt it*: Complete Riverline's local reference-pack/v1 architecture (REFERENCE-STRATEGY-002 / REFERENCE-PACK-001) so users can load verified, license-clean local reference packs (such as authorized HRC exports or private JSON packs) with SHA-256 integrity checks and strict claim ceilings—without requiring a Windows solver tower or cloud subscription [Judgement].
5. **Guided Interactive Onboarding (Adapt from Upswing's "Four Categories" & Brilliant's Scaffolding)**:
    - *What they do*: Upswing Lab onboards novices by grouping hands into four intuitive categories before introducing solver complexity, while Brilliant uses interactive step-by-step discovery.
    - *How Riverline must adapt it*: Combine Riverline's skippable, re-openable per-workspace tutorials and workflow-first Guide with interactive Bluff/Exploit Teacher lessons (value targets, bluff-catchers, semibluff economics) that use actual table manipulation rather than passive video lectures [Judgement].

3.3 DIFFERENTIATE (Where Riverline Should Deliberately Do the Opposite)

1. **Personal Strategy Elicitation vs. "Solver Worship"**:
    - *Industry norm*: Every GTO trainer (GTO Wizard, DTO, GTOBase) treats a single presolved equilibrium as objective law and grades any human deviation as an "error" or "blunder."
    - *Riverline's opposite stance*: **Riverline learns how *you* think about poker**

(Personal Strategy), helps you make your own game plan coherent across environments, and compares your intended strategy, your observed training play, and a selected reference baseline side-by-side without calling deliberate exploitative deviations "mistakes" [Judgement].

2. **Dominant-Action Elicitation with Honest Mixes vs. Binary Quiz Grading or 169-Cell Painting**:
    - *Industry norm*: Trainers either force tedious 169-cell manual matrix painting (Flopzilla, FreeBetRange) or grade mixed spots as binary right/wrong quizzes that punish 40% mixed lines (DTO).
    - *Riverline's opposite stance*: Elicit strategy through fast, one-click situational hand prompts where a click records the **dominant/preferred action** (never silently coerced into 100% purity), while surfacing close reference mixes honestly (e.g., *"3-Bet or Call"*) and offering optional mixed-frequency refinement only at informative boundaries [Judgement].
3. **First-Class Home-Game, Live, and ClubGG Accounting vs. Online-Only 6-Max Silos**:
    - *Industry norm*: Solvers hardcode 6-max 100bb online rake structures and refuse to allow multi-limp pots, custom seat counts (2–10 players), or non-standard forced contributions (TwoPlusTwo Live Cash Thread).
    - *Riverline's opposite stance*: Treat **2–10 player Home Games (zero rake)** and **ClubGG-style 7–10 player tournaments (exact 0.1bb per-seat per-hand contribution outside the contestable pot)**, full-ring table physicality, and manual/live hand reconstruction (Hand Mode vs lossy Scenario Mode) as first-class citizens [Judgement].
4. **Calm, Free, Local-First Workstation vs. Predatory Cloud "Rentalism"**:
    - *Industry norm*: Cloud platforms lock formats, stack depths, and historical review behind $40–279$/month recurring subscriptions and track device identifiers (r/poker Pricing Thread, Live Poker Trainer).
    - *Riverline's opposite stance*: Deliver a complete, private-by-default, local-first workstation that works in the browser (Firefox-first) and Electron without requiring an account, server, or subscription to study, reconstruct hands, calibrate personal ranges, or run exact equity math [Judgement].

3.4 REJECT (Ideas & Patterns to Explicitly Exclude, with Reasons)

1. **Fake Precision, Unverified "EV Loss" Numbers, and Heuristic-as-GTO Labels**:
    - *Seen in*: PokerSnowie ("Error Rate" derived from a flawed neural network) and low-tier mobile trainers.
    - *Why reject*: Presenting heuristic or interpolated estimates as exact big-blind EV losses violates Riverline's core truthfulness contract. Until an exact, validated reference pack covers a node, Riverline must label heuristic outputs as exploratory/comparative baseline evidence and fail closed on normative EV claims [Judgement].
2. **Vanity Score Curving & Patronizing Dopamine Badges ("Brilliant!!", CAPS2 50–95 Curve)**:
    - *Seen in*: Chess.com CAPS2 Accuracy and rating-inflated "Brilliant!!" move labels (Move Classifications).
    - *Why reject*: Artificially curving scores so beginners "don't feel bad" or handing out fake exclamation points destroys analytical trust among serious learners (r/chess

Pricing Thread). Riverline's Midnight/Graphite/Daylight workstation aesthetic is calm, adult, and candid [Judgement].

3. **Coercive Gamification (Daily Key Locks, Forced Linear Progression, XP Leagues)**:
    - *Seen in*: Brilliant.org's 2-keys/day limit and sequential topic lock, plus leaderboard spam in mobile apps.
    - *Why reject*: Blocking a poker player from inspecting a specific spot they just misplayed in their home game until they "unlock earlier levels" is hostile to adult self-directed study. Study goals in Riverline should reflect genuine evidence coverage and scheduled Revisit items, never manipulative streak anxieties [Judgement].
4. **Real-Time Assistance (RTA) Overlays & Live In-Game HUDs**:
    - *Seen in*: GTO Wizard Table Wizard, Hold'em Manager 3, and Hand2Note.
    - *Why reject*: Live HUDs and table overlays blur the line with banned real-time assistance, trigger anti-cheat bans (as seen on GGPoker and PokerStars), and conflict with Riverline's identity as an off-table study and post-session review workstation [Judgement].
5. **Fragmented Single-Feature Apps**:
    - *Seen in*: Crafty Wheel Studios splitting Preflop+, Postflop+, Solver+, and GTO Ranges+ into separate apps.
    - *Why reject*: Forces users to context-switch and re-enter hands across disconnected silos (Best GTO Apps 2026). Riverline's core strength is unifying Hand Play/Replay, Analyze, Training, Equity, Personal Strategy, and Saved inside one coherent shell [Judgement].

4. Unmet Needs of Home-Game and Live Players

Across TwoPlusTwo's Live No-Limit Cash forums, r/poker discussions, and r/Poker_Theory reviews, home-game and live players represent the **largest underserved demographic in poker software** [Judgement]. While they make up the vast majority of recreational and semi-serious players globally, almost every software tool treats them as an afterthought to 6-max online Zoom grinders. Their seven most acute unmet needs are:

4.1 Modeling the "Limp-Family" and Multiway Reality

In live 1/2, 1/3, and home games, the most common preflop sequence is not "UTG opens 2.2bb, BTN 3-bets 7bb, heads-up to the flop." It is **"UTG limps, MP limps, CO raises to 6bb–7bb, BTN calls, and both limpers call—going 4-way to the flop"** (TwoPlusTwo Live Cash Thread). Standard solver libraries either block these action trees entirely ("GTO Wizard says no, no, no, you cannot simulate that hand") or force players into 2-way heads-up approximations where c-betting frequencies and one-pair valuations are dangerously wrong (TwoPlusTwo Live Cash Thread) [Judgement].

- **Riverline Opportunity**: Support legal multi-limp, isolation-raise, and multiway states cleanly in Hand Mode, Analyze, and Equity, and explicitly flag when a spot is multiway so single-raised heads-up heuristics are never misrepresented as multiway truth [Judgement].

4.2 Fast, Honest Post-Session Hand Reconstruction (Without Online

Hand Histories)

Online players import 10,000 hands/second into Hand2Note or HM3. Live and home-game players walk away from the table with **partial memories of 3–5 pivotal hands**: they remember their hole cards, the board, the rough pot size, the key villain's action on the turn/river, and perhaps two dead cards—yet they often *do not* remember whether UTG+1 folded or limped preflop, or the exact stack of Seat 4 (TwoPlusTwo Live Cash Thread) [Judgement].

- **Riverline Opportunity**: Riverline's architectural separation between **canonical Hand Mode** (full legal state, exact contributions, side pots, and replay) and **lossy Scenario Mode** (fast study snapshot where exact history may be incomplete and is never fabricated) directly solves the live player's reconstruction dilemma [Judgement].

4.3 Persistent, Named Profiles for Recurring Human Opponents and Game Environments

In an online pool of 5,000 anonymous players, population-level GTO or Mass Data Analysis (MDA) makes sense (TwoPlusTwo Live Cash Thread). In a weekly home game or local cardroom, **you play against the exact same 8–15 people every week**—each with distinct, stable habits (the friend who never folds top pair, the tight older regular who only 3-bets KK+, the maniac who bluffs missed flush draws) (r/poker Live Thread).

- **Riverline Opportunity**: Riverline's Personal Strategy profiles (e.g., *Home Game with Friends*, *ClubGG Freeroll*, *Friday 1/2 Live*) and Bluff/Exploit Teacher opponent policies allow a player to build, calibrate, and refine concrete game plans tailored to their specific real-world table rather than an imaginary equilibrium bot [Judgement].

4.4 Warning Against "Piecemeal GTO" Traps (Multi-Street Plan Coherence)

Live players on TwoPlusTwo repeatedly describe losing money after adopting isolated solver habits—such as firing 25%–33% flop c-bets against loose-passive live callers without realizing that small flop sizing only works in equilibrium when paired with high-frequency turn overbets and river barrels against opponents who actually fold to pressure (TwoPlusTwo Live Cash Thread).

- **Riverline Opportunity**: Emphasize **multi-street plan coherence and opponent-response sensitivity** (via Personal Hand flop/turn/river continuation and Bluff/Exploit Teacher candidate economics) so users see *how* an action depends on whether the opponent overfolds, calls inelastically, or rarely check-raises [Judgement].

4.5 Non-Casino Accounting: Zero-Rake Home Games, ClubGG Per-Seat Contributions, and Variable Stack Depth

Commercial solvers assume 5% capped casino/online rake at a uniform 100bb effective stack (Vision FAQ). Home games typically run **zero rake** with wildly uneven stacks (e.g., 40bb short stacks alongside 250bb deep stacks), while private online club games (such as **ClubGG**) often use a fixed per-seat hand fee (such as Riverline's exact 0.1bb per seated player outside the contestable pot) that alters preflop pot economics compared to percentage postflop drop [Judgement].

- **Riverline Opportunity**: Riverline's canonical accounting rules for 2–10 player zero-rake Home Games and 7–10 player ClubGG-style 0.1bb/seat contributions—plus exact actor-relative call pricing (DECISION-ECONOMICS-001)—give home-game and club players honest pot math that no commercial trainer models [Judgement].

4.6 Economics That Respect Occasional Play Volume

As adonson and Tomark calculated on TwoPlusTwo, a recreational live or home-game player who plays 10–25 hours a month cannot financially justify a 99–150/month solver subscription—paying $8.90 per hour of table play to rent software is itself a massive bankroll leak (TwoPlusTwo Live Cash Thread, r/poker GTO Apps Thread).

- **Riverline Opportunity**: By remaining **free and local-first**, Riverline removes the subscription clock entirely—allowing a weekly home-game player to study for 5 minutes before a Friday game or review 3 saved hands on Sunday without subscription guilt [Judgement].

4.7 Integrated Home-Game Session & Ledger Continuity

Home-game hosts and regular players currently juggle separate apps for tracking buy-ins/rebuys/cash-outs and studying hands. When a big all-in pot happens at the kitchen table or in a private game, players want to record the session ledger accurately *and* bookmark that exact hand for post-game Review, Equity runout inspection, and Saved library discussion [Judgement].

- **Riverline Opportunity**: Riverline's unified Home Game organizer (Correct entries with append-only auditability for buy-ins, rebuys, add-ons, and cash-outs) connected to canonical Hand replay, Equity, and Saved study objects bridges the gap between running a home game and studying it [Judgement].

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